

freedom. Each small achievement unlocked parts of a world she had never known, making her feel more alive and powerful. Kamla's journey was not just about acquiring a new skill; it was about rediscovering and reclaiming herself. She found the courage to dream, explore, and grow, rewriting her own story despite the challenges she faced.

Case 3: At just 19, Hitesh's world shattered. He had already lost his father as a child, and when his mother passed away recently, he was left completely alone, struggling daily for survival. Desperate for change, he joined ASDC as a GDA student. The journey was tough, but ASDC became his lifeline, providing him with practical skills, hope, and the strength to rebuild his life.

After completing his training, Hitesh secured a job at CIMS Hospital in Ahmedabad. Walking through the hospital in his uniform felt like a new beginning. Despite this progress, Hitesh still carries unfulfilled dreams. He imagines owning a car, a symbol of independence, and longs to reconnect with his estranged sister, now married. His deepest wish is to care for her, as family is all he has left. Hitesh's journey from loss to rebuilding is a testament to quiet resilience and hope.

Bridging skill gap

ASDC, an initiative by the Adani Foundation, is committed to bridging India's skill gap through the provision of exceptional vocational training. In alignment with the Government of India's Skill India Mission, ASDC strives to empower the nation's youth, transforming them into 'Saksham' (capable) professionals poised to attain their career aspirations and contribute significantly to nation-building.

ASDC envisions a future where individuals are skilled, employable, and entrepreneurial, enabling them to either embark upon or advance their careers while simultaneously elevating the social and economic fabric of the country. Its mission is to offer a transformative educational experience, narrowing the industry skill gap and fostering a collaborative atmosphere that encourages the free exchange of ideas, and supports research, creativity, innovation, and entrepreneurship with an eye on sustainable livelihoods.

In line with SDGs

ASDC's efforts are in line with several Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), including No Poverty, Zero Hunger, Good Health and Well-Being, Quality Education, Gender Equality, Affordable and Clean Energy, Decent Work and Economic Growth, and Partnerships for the Goals. The Centre incorporates advanced technology into its training methodologies, presenting over

70 online courses via its Learning Management System, simulation-based assessments, and both software and hardware simulation training. Specialised training areas cover domestic electrical wiring, augmented reality welding, and operating heavy machinery such as cranes, dumpers, excavators, and loaders.

Accolades for excellence

ASDC's unwavering commitment to excellence has been recognised through numerous accolades. These include the India Sustainability Award 2022 for SDG/Impact Leader of the Year, the ASSOCHAM Award for Best Institute for Women Development (2019), the CSR Times Award for Best Corporate Foundation for Women Empowerment (2019), the Silver Stevie Award for Technical Advancement (2023), the CII DX Award

for Best Practice in Digital Transformation (2023), and international honours such as the Gold Brandon Hall Award for Best Advance in Unique Learning Technology (2022) and the Gold Stevie Award for Organization of the Year – Non-Profit (2022).

The ASDC impact

Since its establishment in 2016, ASDC has trained over 160,000 youth, achieving a 68% livelihood ratio across 15 states through more than 40 skill development centres. With over 70 industry-aligned courses, ASDC utilises a hybrid model blending online education with hands-on training. Boasting the largest library of simulation-based training and pioneering programmes in the metaverse, ASDC remains at the forefront of skill development in India.

